Biodiversity/Environment and natural disaster management, culture and people to people contact.

One achievement of BIMSTEC is the setting up of BIMSTEC Free Trade Area Framework Agreement on 8 February 2004. The Framework Agreement includes trade in goods, trade in services, investment and economic cooperation and the products, except those included in the Negative List, shall be subject to tariff reduction or elimination on the basis of fast track or normal track. BIMSTEC grouping also signed a convention in December 2009, to combat terrorism and agreed to conclude a Free Trade Agreement (FTA) soon. Apart from the convention on terrorism, the grouping adopted a Memoranda of Association (MoA) on the establishment of a BIMSTEC Energy centre, a centre for Weather and Climate and a Cultural Industries Observatory.

India views the seven-nation organization as ‘a bridge’ linking South and South-east Asia with India’s north-eastern states, and underline the need for greater regional economic integration. This is also part of India’s Look-East Policy. If India succeeds in cementing her ties with BIMSTEC, then economic engagements with the member countries would help India to tackle Chinese policy of isolating India.

Second Summit of BIMSTEC was hosted by India, New Delhi on 13 November 2008. Member states agreed to intensify efforts to strengthen cooperation and also establish institutional structures to implement and coordinate Summit decisions, Ministerial meetings and other official meeting follow ups and establish a permanent secretariat.

The Third BIMSTEC Summit Meeting took place on 1–4 March 2014 at Nay Pyi Taw, Myanmar and was attended by Prime Ministers of Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand. It was decided that the fourth BIMSTEC Energy Ministerial Meeting was to be held in Bhutan in 2015 after the Third in Nepal. Among other important activities of the BIMSTEC, the member countries applauded the creation of BIMSTEC Network of Policy Think Tanks, agreed to promote BIMSTEC Network of National Centres of Coordination, recognized the role of BIMSTEC Energy Centre in Bengaluru, expressed desire to improve people-people